since 1980. Ecologists are amassing datasets that will enable in-depth knowledge to be shared.

A forest ecosystem

One of the six original research sites is Andrews Forest in Oregon. It provides a good example of a temperate rain forest, enjoying mild, wet winters and cool, dry summers. With 40 percent being old-growth conifer forest, there is a high degree of biodiversity across its forest, stream, and meadow ecosystems. Ecologists have recorded thousands of species of insects, 83 bird species, 19 conifer species, and 9 species of fish. Projects aim to observe how land-use (such as forestry) and natural phenomena (fires, floods, climate) affect hydrology, biodiversity, and carbon dynamics —the way carbon and nutrients move through the ecosystem. There are many other long-term research sites worldwide with researchers logging data on ecosystems. With free access to the information, the research can be easily disseminated globally.